

How to Fix the "Entry Point Not Found" Error on Windows

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How to Fix the "Entry Point Not Found" Error on Windows

How to Fix the "Entry Point Not Found" Error on Windows

By [Shan Abdul](#)

Published Mar 3, 2023

Source : <https://www.makeuseof.com/entry-point-not-found-error-windows/>

The "Entry Point not found" error on Windows is usually due to a missing DLL file. Here's how to fix it.



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The "Entry point not found" error occurs when a DLL file is missing in the app or software's directory or if the app or software cannot access it. Often, the error message specifies the name of the missing file; occasionally, it does not. For this reason, this error message may appear in different forms. In any case, the leading cause would be the same; a missing or inaccessible DLL file.

In this article, we'll explain what you can do to retrieve the missing DLL file or make it accessible to the game or software so that it can run properly.

You can watch this video :

<https://video.makeuseofimages.com/2024/03/how-to-fix-the-entry-point-not-found-error-on-windows-1711079421.mp4>

How to Fix the "Entry Point Not Found" Error on Windows

1. Disable the Microsoft Defender Firewall or Antivirus

Virus & threat protection settings

View and update Virus & threat protection settings for Microsoft Defender Antivirus.

Have a question?

[Get help](#)

Real-time protection

Locates and stops malware from installing or running on your device. You can turn off this setting for a short time before it turns back on automatically.

 On

Help improve Windows Security

[Give us feedback](#)

Cloud-delivered protection

Provides increased and faster protection with access to the latest protection data in the cloud. Works best with Automatic sample submission turned on.

 On

Change your privacy :

View and change privacy settings for your Windows Home Single Language

[Privacy settings](#)

[Privacy dashboard](#)

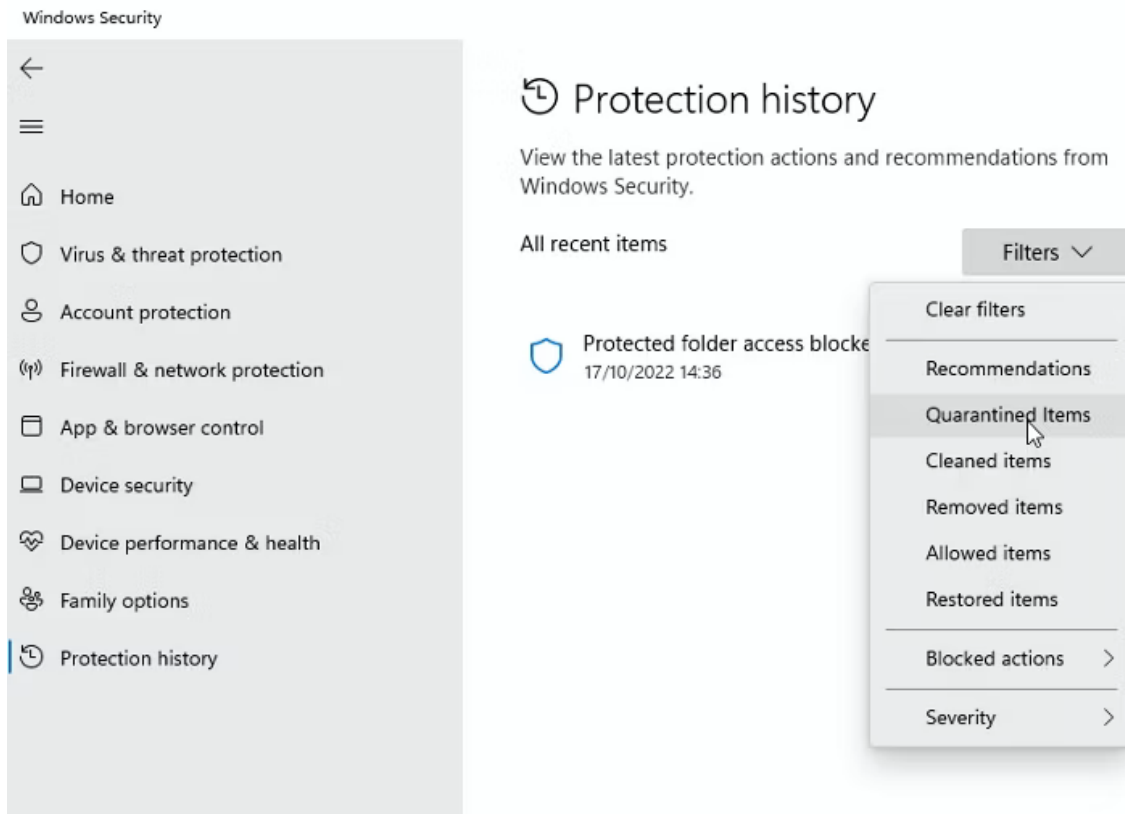
[Privacy Statement](#)

Microsoft Defender or the antivirus software you use can block the app's access to a DLL file that the app fails to find. The security software can also delete a DLL file if they deem it a threat. So, you should [disable the Microsoft Defender Firewall](#) or any antivirus software you use. By doing so, you can rule out both of these possibilities.

After disabling Microsoft Defender or antivirus, run the app or software again. If you encounter the same error again, the app's lack of access to the DLL file is probably not the issue; the DLL file is most likely missing.

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2. Restore the Missing DLL File From the List of Quarantined Files



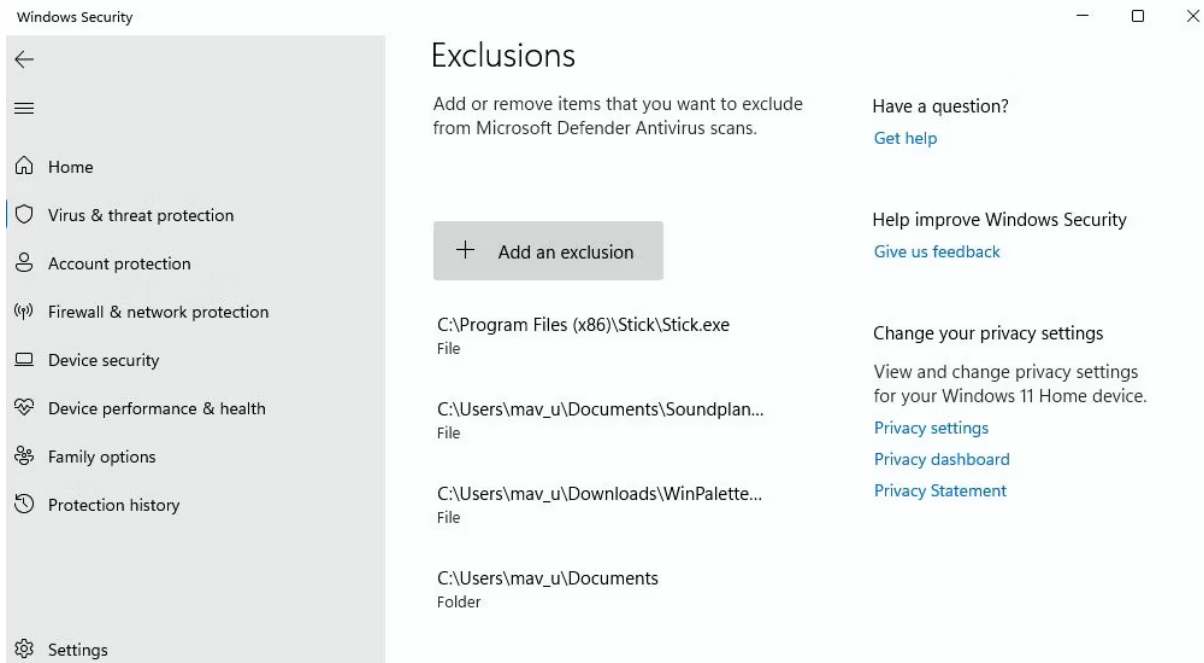
Most DLL files are automatically installed when you install apps, and we rarely need to download them manually. However, sometimes, the security software we use can quarantine or delete some of these files, believing they are malicious.

So, once you have disabled the antivirus, you should check the list of files that Microsoft Defender or your antivirus has quarantined. If you find the missing DLL file in that list, you can restore it.

The [process of restoring quarantined files in Microsoft Defender](#) is quite simple. So, if you know the name of the missing file that may have been mentioned in the error message, you should check the quarantined files for it and restore it.

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3. Exclude the DLL File From the Microsoft Defender Firewall or Your Antivirus



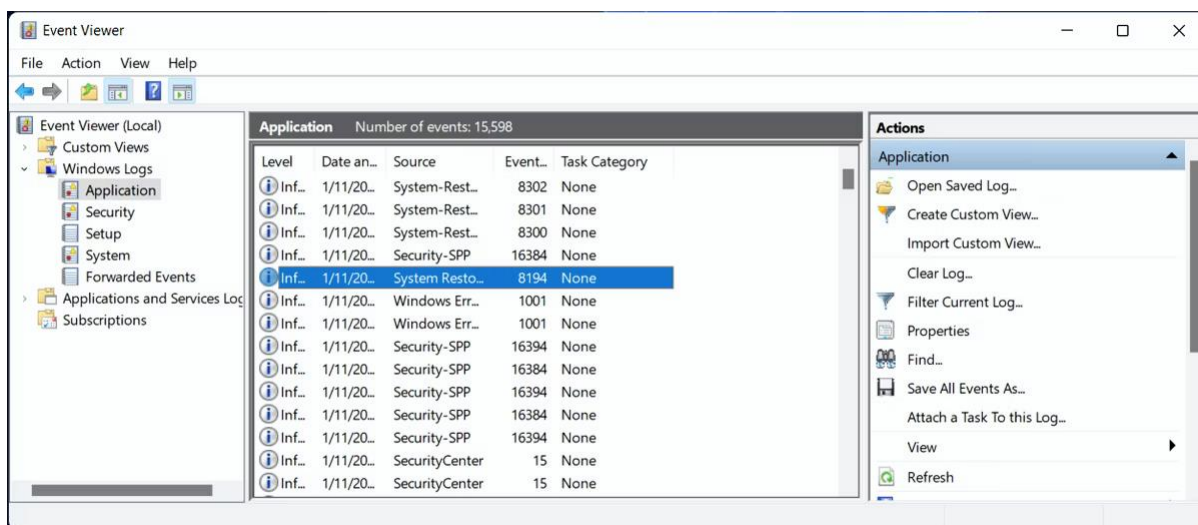
Whether you've successfully restored the missing DLL file from quarantined files or manually downloaded it from an external source, it's essential to whitelist this file from Microsoft Defender or your antivirus before turning on the security software again.

Doing so will prevent these applications from deleting, quarantining, or blocking the file again in the future. So, copy the path to the DLL file you've restored or downloaded recently, and [whitelist the file in Microsoft Defender](#) and your antivirus software.

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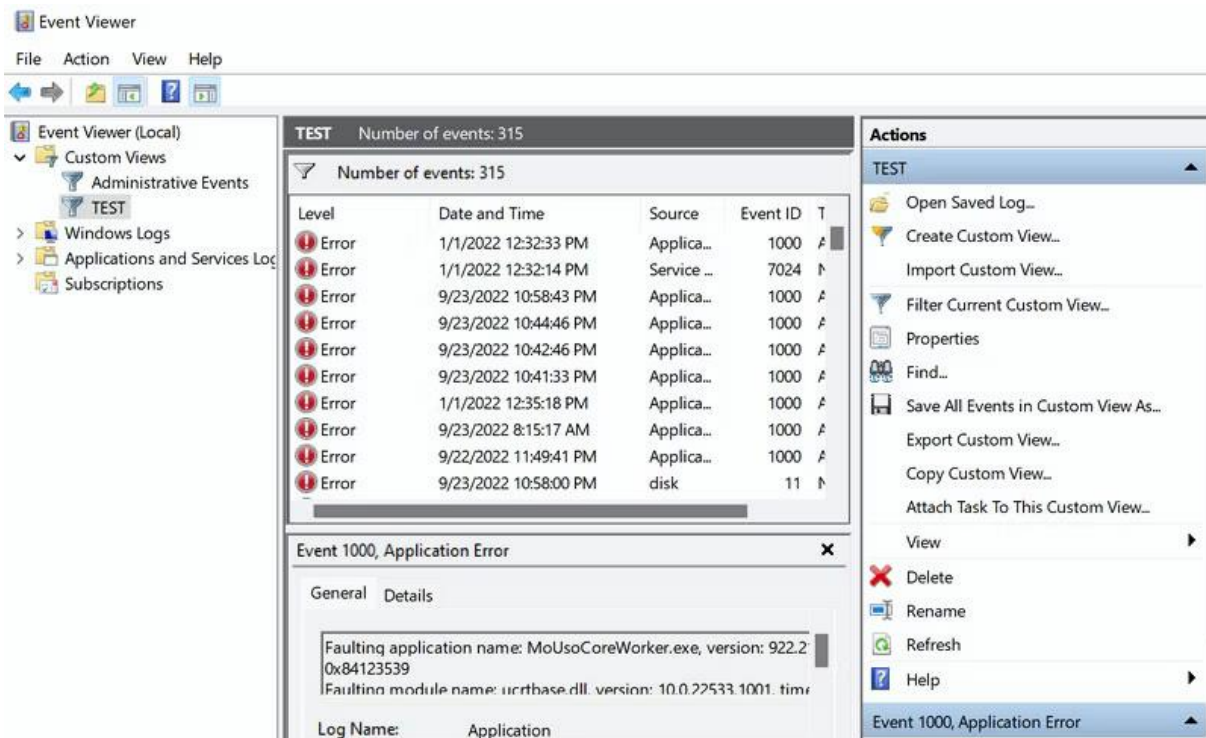
4. Is There No Mention of the Missing DLL File in the Error Message? See the Event Viewer

If the error window does not mention the missing DLL file, you can check its details in Event Viewer, a Windows tool that lets you analyze event logs. Type "**Event Viewer**" in Windows Search and launch **Event Viewer**. Then, expand the **Windows Logs** category from the left pane and go to the **Application** section.



Here, find the event specific to the app where you have encountered the error. You'll most likely find the relevant event at the top, meaning it would be recently created. The easiest way to identify such an event is by looking at events with "**Error**" written under the **Level** column.

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After finding the relevant event, double-click it to view its details. You'll find its details in the **General** tab.

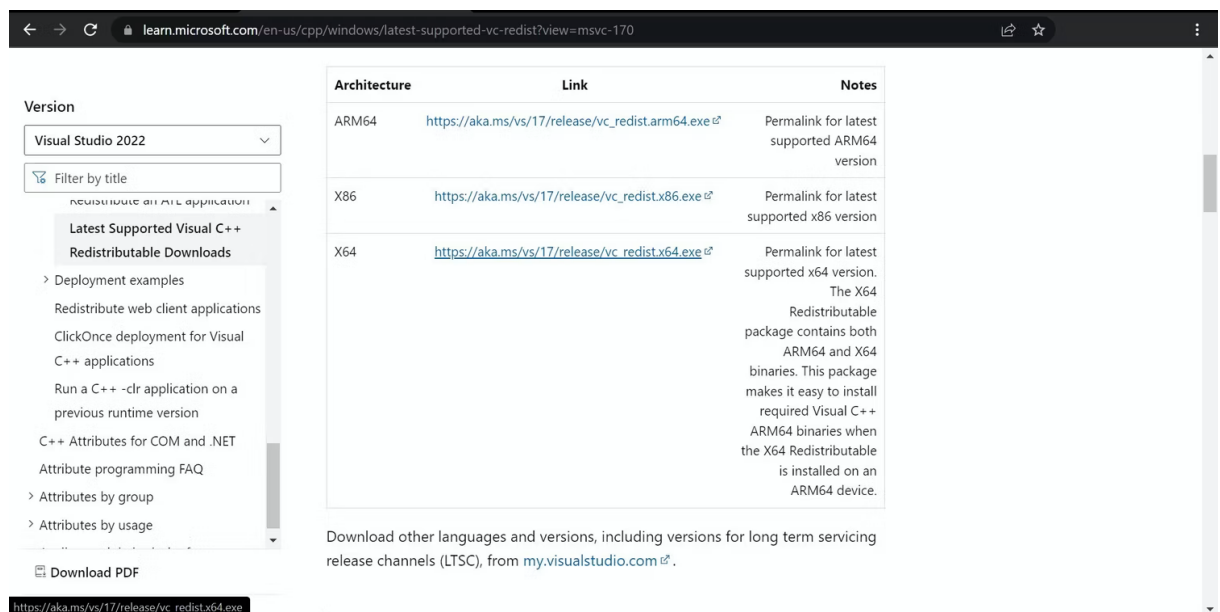
Take note of the missing file name from there and restore it from the quarantined files or download it externally. Once you have done that, don't forget to exclude it from Microsoft Defender and your antivirus.

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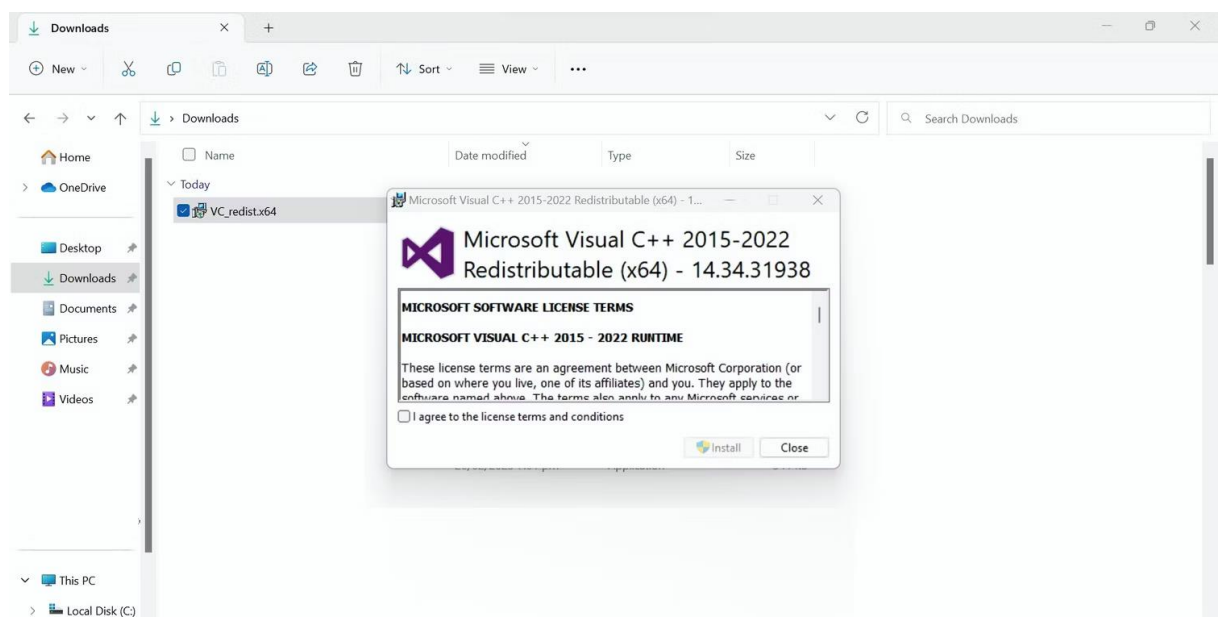
5. Install the Missing Visual C++ Redistributable Packages

If none of the above solutions have helped you fix the problem, your last resort should be to install the Visual C++ Redistributable packages. Reinstalling them usually fixes the missing DLL files problem. So, give it a shot. To install them, follow these steps:

1. Go to the [Microsoft Visual C++](https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/cpp/windows/latest-supported-vc-redist?view=msvc-170) download page.
2. If your device runs 64-bit Windows, click the **x64** link for the latest Visual Studio 2015, 2017, 2019, and 2022 packs. If your PC has a different Windows version, click the relevant link.

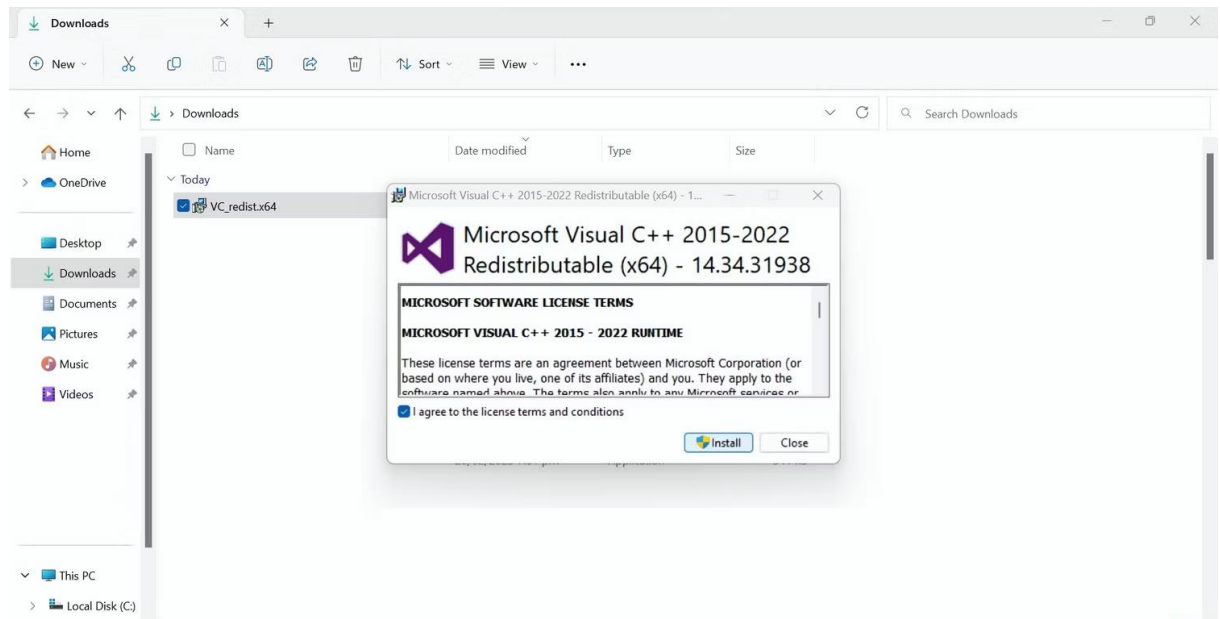


3. Once the **VC_redist.x64.exe** file has been downloaded, double-click it.



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4. Check the box for **I agree to the license terms and conditions**.
5. Click **Install**.



6. Click **Yes** in the **UAC** window.
7. Close the window once the installation is complete.
8. Reboot your computer once.

Hopefully, reinstalling this package will resolve the issue. If it doesn't work, uninstall and reinstall the problematic app. When reinstalling it, keep Microsoft Defender or your antivirus disabled to prevent them from deleting the DLL file again.

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What About Manually Downloading the DLL File From an Online Library?

You may be tempted to simply re-download the missing DLL file from an online source, but we do not recommend it. Downloading DLL files online can be risky; sometimes the DLL file is designed for a different version of Windows or the app you're using, which can cause further problems. And shady websites can lace the DLL file with malware.

As such, you should only download a DLL as a last resort. And it's better to figure out why the error is being thrown, as re-downloading the DLL file won't fix the reason it went missing to begin with.

Fix the "Entry Point Not Found" Error on Windows , advice.

The "Entry point not found" error indicates that a DLL file is missing from the app's directory. By following the above steps, you will be able to restore the missing DLL file or download it from an external source and manually add it. This will eventually fix the problem, and the app or program will resume working.

Lastly, always download DLL files only from legitimate and trusted sources. You could become vulnerable to identity theft if you download them from unknown or third-party sources.

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How to Turn Off or Disable the Microsoft Defender Firewall in Windows 11

By [Digvijay Kumar](#)

Published Jan 4, 2023

Source : <https://www.makeuseof.com/windows-11-disable-microsoft-defender-firewall/>



While firewalls can protect you from malicious online threats, there may be times when it is necessary to disable them for certain tasks or applications. While it's usually not a good idea to disable the firewall for long periods of time, doing so for a few seconds while you troubleshoot a problem is usually safe.

As such, let's explore how to turn off or disable the Microsoft Defender firewall safely and securely in Windows 11.

How Important Is the Microsoft Defender Firewall?

A firewall acts as a shield against unwanted intrusions and prevents external connections from accessing your system without permission. When disabled, your computer becomes vulnerable, and you should take extra precautions while online.

To ensure maximum security while disabling your firewall, always make sure that other protective measures such as antivirus programs are running in the background. Once these have been taken care of, you can disable the firewall on your Windows 11 PC.

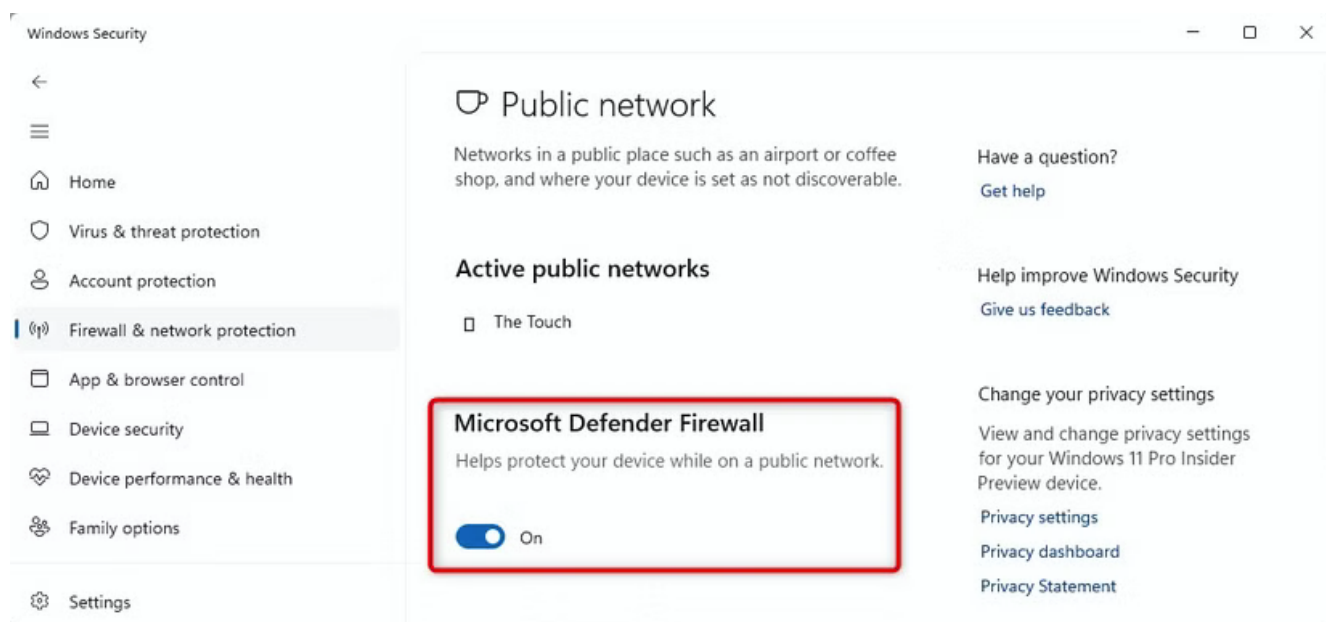
Here's how to turn off the Microsoft Defender Firewall on Windows 11 for troubleshooting purposes.

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1. How to Disable the Firewall Using Windows Security

The Windows Security program allows you to disable the firewall in Windows 11. It is the most straightforward way to disable Microsoft Defender Firewall and you don't need to have any additional tools or software installed. Here's how:

1. Click on **Start** and search for "Windows Security".
2. Then select the result from the top of the list.
3. Once you are in Windows Security, click on the **Firewall & network protection** option.
4. Select the **Public network** or **Private network** profile and turn off the firewall for that selection.



The UAC prompt will require you to accept it, so make sure your computer is set up as an admin account. If UAC prompts on the screen, click **Yes** to continue.

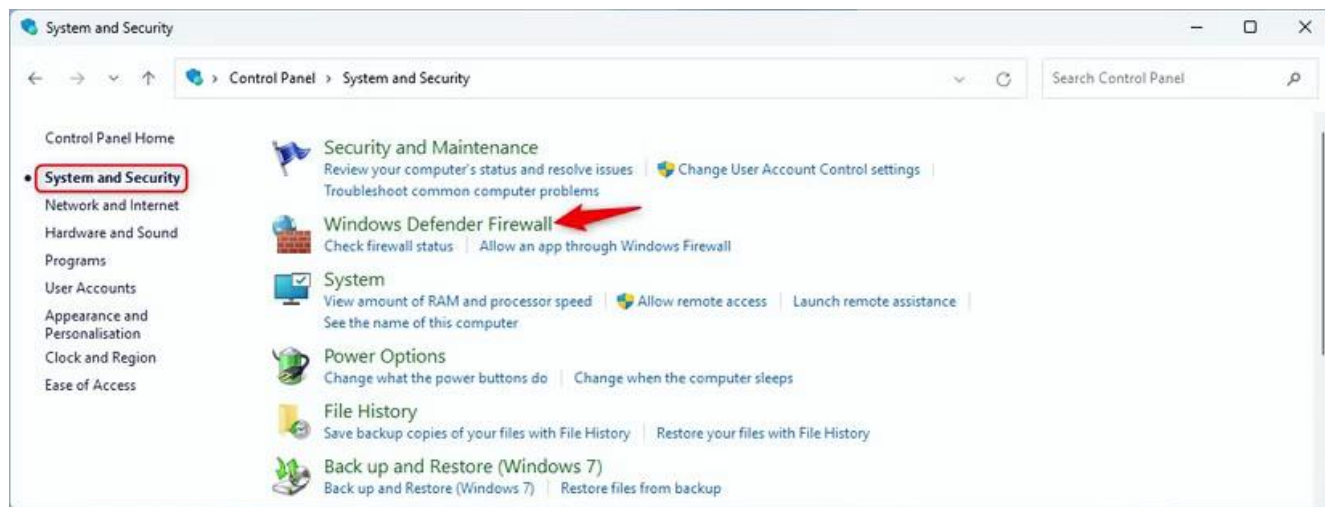
Now that you have completed the above steps, disable the firewall for each network profile using the same procedure.

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2. How to Disable the Firewall Through Control Panel

If you are running an older version of Windows or prefer to use a more traditional method, you can disable your firewall through the Control Panel. This is a bit more technical than using Windows Security but still easy enough to do. Here's how:

1. Open the Control Panel. If you need help with this, check out [how to open the Control Panel in Windows 11](#).



2. In the Control Panel, select **System and Security** and then click **Windows Defender Firewall**.
3. From the left pane, select **Turn Windows Defender Firewall on or off**.



4. Then select **Turn off Windows Defender Firewall (not recommended)** for each network setting.
5. Click **OK** to save your changes.

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3. How to Disable the Firewall Using Command Prompt

If you are comfortable using the command line, then you can also disable your firewall through the Command Prompt. Here's how:

Press **Win + S** on your keyboard to open the Windows search tool. Now type "cmd" in the search field and press **Ctrl + Shift + Enter** on your keyboard. This will open Command Prompt with admin rights.

Once you are in the Command Prompt, type in the following command and hit **Enter**:

```
netsh advfirewall set currentprofile state off
```

Running the above command will turn off the firewall for the current network profile.

If you wish to disable the firewall for the domain network profile, copy and paste the following command, and hit **Enter**:

```
netsh advfirewall set domainprofile state off
```

Similarly, you can disable the firewall for the private network profile. To do this, copy and paste the following command and hit **Enter**:

```
netsh advfirewall set privateprofile state off
```

For the public network profile, type the following command in the Command Prompt window and press **Enter**:

```
netsh advfirewall set publicprofile state off
```

Alternatively, you can disable the Defender Firewall for all network profiles, such as domain, private, and public, with just one command. To do this, copy and paste the below command and hit **Enter**:

```
netsh advfirewall set allprofiles state off
```

In this way, you can disable the firewall according to your selected network profiles.

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4. How to Turn Off the Firewall via PowerShell

Windows PowerShell is an important tool that can be used to manage many aspects of the Windows operating system. You can also use it to disable the Microsoft Defender Firewall.

To do this, open a PowerShell window as an administrator and run the following commands:

A screenshot of a Windows PowerShell window titled "Administrator: PowerShell". The window has a dark background. The text inside shows the PowerShell version "PowerShell 7.3.1", the prompt "PS C:\Users\Digvijay Kumar>", and the command "Set-NetFirewallProfile -Profile Domain,Public,Private -Enabled False" being entered. The prompt "PS C:\Users\Digvijay Kumar>" appears again on the next line, indicating the command has been executed.

```
PowerShell 7.3.1
PS C:\Users\Digvijay Kumar> Set-NetFirewallProfile -Profile Domain,Public,Private -Enabled False
PS C:\Users\Digvijay Kumar>
```

```
Set-NetFirewallProfile -Profile Domain,Public,Private -Enabled False
```

After running the above command, the firewall will be disabled for all network profiles simultaneously.

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5. How to Turn Off the Firewall Using Group Policy Editor

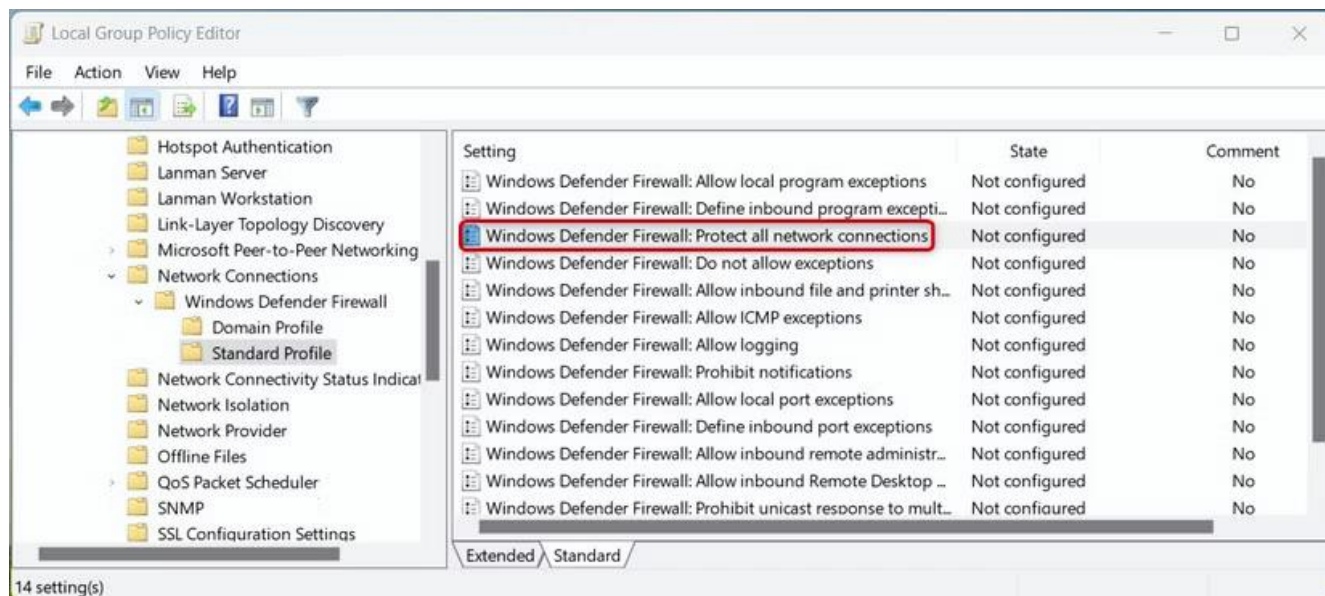
The Group Policy Editor is a powerful system resource that can be used to manage different settings on all Windows computers. With this tool, you can disable your firewall, but it only works with Windows Professional and Enterprise. If you are using Windows Home Edition, you need to [activate the Group Policy Editor on Windows Home](#) in order to access it.

To disable firewall settings using the Local group policy editor, follow these steps:

1. Right-click on Start and select **Run** from the menu list.
2. Type **gpedit.msc** in the dialog box and click **OK** or press Enter on your keyboard.
3. Inside the Group Policy Editor window, navigate to the following:

Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Network > Network Connections > Windows Defender Firewall > Standard Profile

4. On the right side of the window, double-click the policy called **Windows Defender Firewall: Protect all network connections**.



5. Next, choose **Disabled** from the dialog box that appears.
6. When you're done making your changes, click **Apply** > **OK**.
7. For the changes to take effect, restart your computer after completing the above steps.

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6. How to Turn Off the Firewall Using Registry Editor

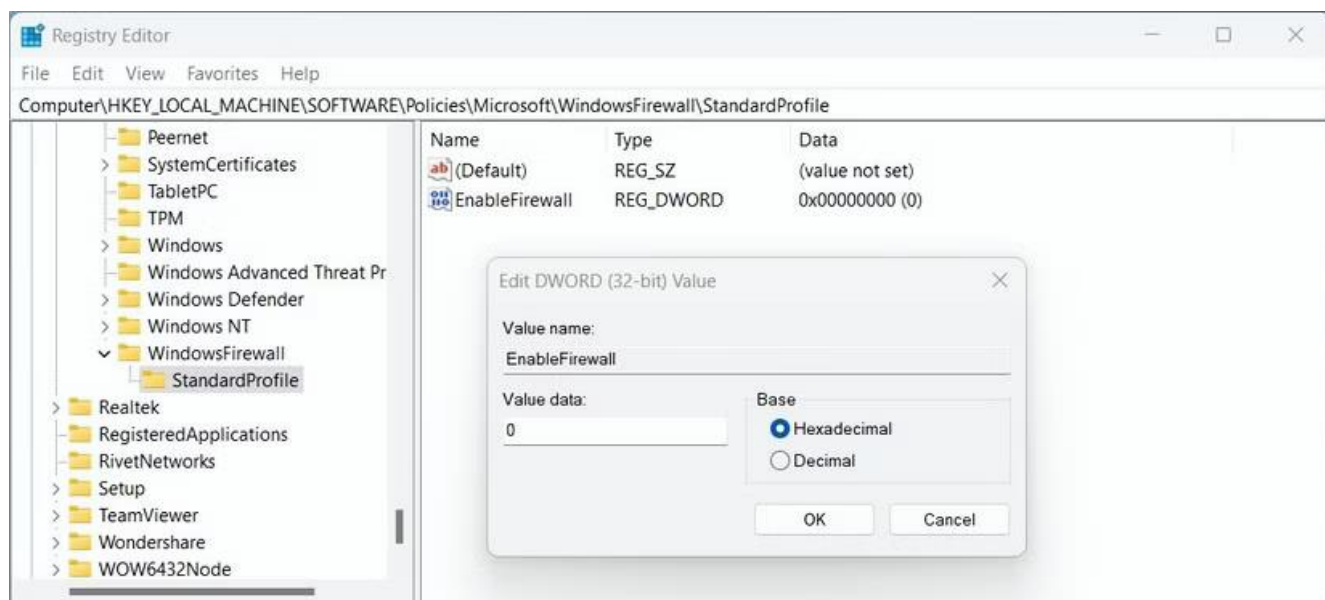
Windows also has a method for disabling the firewall that involves editing the registry. It is an advanced feature that should only be used by experienced computer users, as incorrect usage can cause serious damage to your computer.

When using the Registry Editor, it is important not to modify any other settings than those related directly to the firewall. Making unwanted changes could potentially lead to instability within your system, including a decrease in performance or even the complete failure of your operating system. If you're ready to use this method, make sure you [back up your Windows Registry](#) and [create a restore point on Windows 11](#) first.

1. Open the Registry Editor (see [how to open the Registry Editor](#) for instructions).
2. Once you're in, navigate to the following path:

```
Computer\HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\WindowsFirewall\StandardProfile
```

3. Right-click StandardProfile and select **New > DWORD (32-bit) Value**.
4. Specify **EnableFirewall** as the key name.
5. Double-click it and enter **0** in the Value data field.



6. Once you have made the changes, click **OK**.

When you have completed all the steps above, close the Registry Editor and restart your computer.

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Disable the Firewall With Ease on Windows

You may want to disable the firewall for testing, developing applications, or playing online games. However, disabling the firewall can have risks, and you should always exercise caution. In case you need to do it, this guide explains multiple ways to do it, such as via Windows Security, Control Panel, Command Prompt, and more.

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How to Restore a Quarantined File in Microsoft Defender



By [Russ Ware](#)

Published Nov 22, 2022

Source : <https://www.makeuseof.com/microsoft-defender-restore-quarantined-file/>

Microsoft Defender antivirus is a reliable choice to protect your Windows PC. It consistently scores high in AV tests, includes multiple scan options, and provides several extra tools. But that doesn't mean it's infallible and immune from alerting to false positives.

Here's what to do if Defender quarantines a file you know to be safe.

Why Would Defender Quarantine a Safe File?

Microsoft Defender is generally good at not alerting to safe files. As long as the virus definitions are kept up to date (especially if you learn [how to manually update Windows Defender](#)), false positives are rare. But they do happen.

Defender provides strong protection by being proactive and will quarantine potential threats, as well as active ones. Files are usually flagged as suspicious due to a mismatched or expired digital signature. It can also occur if the file has been incorrectly reported as dangerous.

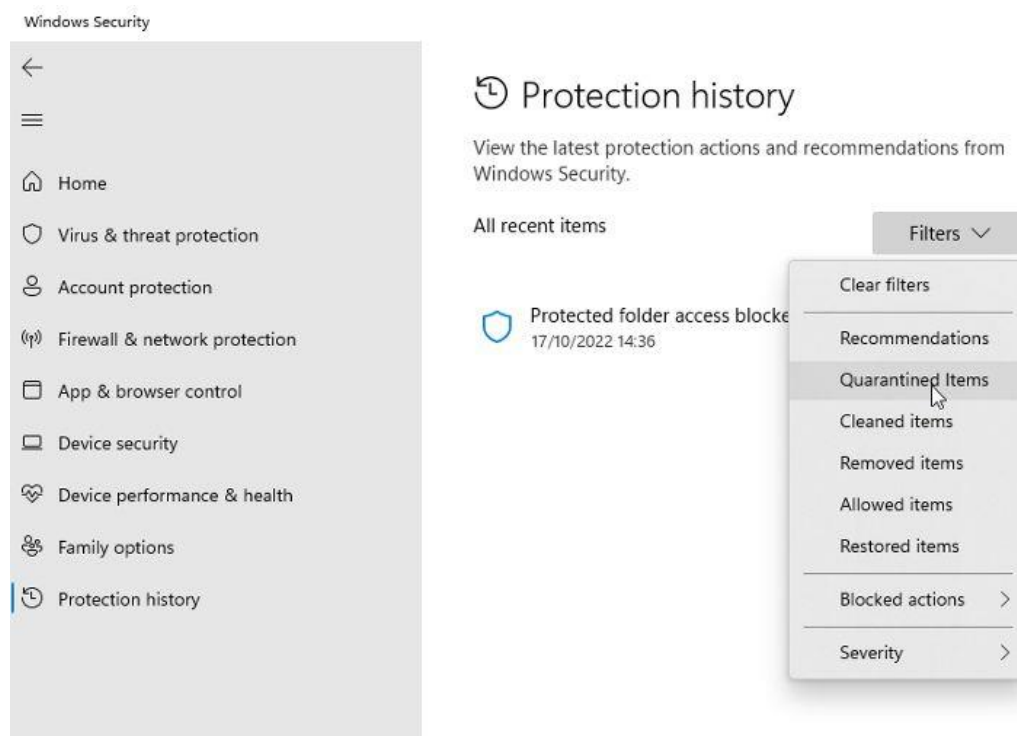
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How to Restore a Quarantined File in Defender

Suspicious files will usually be quarantined rather than automatically deleted. This means they're put in a secure holding state so you can decide whether or not they should be deleted. However, in some situations, files confirmed to be infected will be deleted to protect your system.

You can find recently quarantined files in the Protection History.

1. Open **Settings > Privacy & Security > Windows Security**, and click the **Open Windows Security** button.
2. Select **Virus & Threat Protection** and click the **Protection History** option below the Scan button.



3. You can filter the protection history to display quarantined files using the button at the top.
4. Locate the file you want to restore and select it. You can then choose the option to restore it.

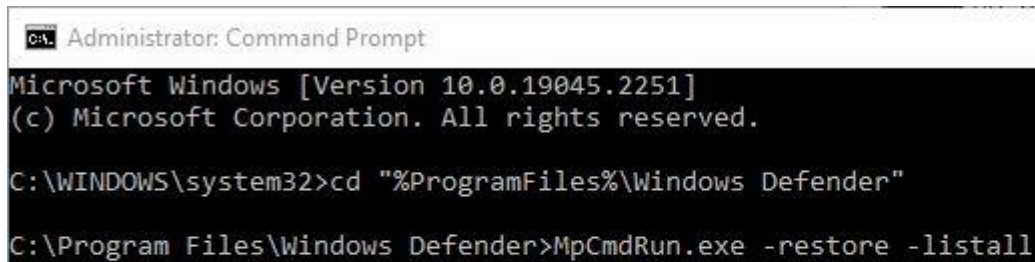
To prevent the file from being flagged again, you can add it to the list of exclusions. You can find this option in the Virus & Threat Protection Settings. If you need more help, check out our guide about [adding exclusions to Microsoft Defender antivirus](#).

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How to Restore a Quarantined File Using Command Prompt

If you can't access the Windows Security app, for some reason, you can restore quarantined files in Command Prompt (elevated).

1. In Windows Search, type Command Prompt and click the **Run as Administrator** option.
2. In Command Prompt, enter the following command: **cd “%ProgramFiles%\Windows Defender”**.
3. Then type: **MpCmdRun.exe -restore -listall** to see a list of all currently quarantined files.



```
Administrator: Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.19045.2251]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\WINDOWS\system32>cd "%ProgramFiles%\Windows Defender"

C:\Program Files\Windows Defender>MpCmdRun.exe -restore -listall
```

4. You can restore a single file by typing: **MpCmdRun.exe -restore -name “Filename”**. Replace Filename with the name of the file you want to restore.

If a file was quarantined because it was a potential network threat, you might be unable to restore it. This is usually because the system might no longer have the required [network credentials](#) to access the file.

Restoring Files Quarantined by Microsoft Defender

Microsoft Defender is usually pretty good at spotting safe files among suspicious ones. But it might occasionally quarantine files that you know are safe. On those occasions, you can restore files in either Windows Security or Command Prompt.

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How to Hide or Show the Firewall and Network Protection Area in Windows Security

By [Aman Kumar](#)

Published Dec 16, 2022

Source : <https://www.makeuseof.com/windows-security-hide-show-firewall-network-protection/>

Stop people from compromising your computer's security by hiding the Firewall and Network Protection part of Windows Security.



Do you share your computer with someone else and not want them to access your Firewall & Network protection settings? If yes, then this is the place where you need to be.

In this article, we'll see how you can hide or show the Firewall & Network protection settings area in Windows Security.

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Why It's Important to Hide the Firewall & Network Area in Windows Security

[Windows Security](#) is your one-stop security center to protect your personal data and network settings. It is divided into different security sections for better and faster security management.

One of these is the Firewall & Network protection area. This is where you can view the Microsoft Defender Firewall status and the type of networks your device is connected to. You can also use it to [block or allow an app through the firewall](#) and reset firewall settings.

Therefore, keeping this area hidden is important, especially if you share your computer with someone else. You must be signed in as an administrator if you want to hide the Firewall & Network area, so check out [how to enable or disable the built-in administrator account](#) on Windows if you need to turn it on.

How to Hide or Show Firewall & Network Area in Windows Security Using the Local Group Policy Editor

The Local Group Policy Editor is a utility using which you can manage parts of Windows, enforce specific policies, and automate repetitive tasks like mapping printers. This utility is reserved for the Professional, Enterprise, and Education editions of Windows. Thus, if you are using the Home edition, check out our guide on how to [access the group policy editor in Windows Home](#).

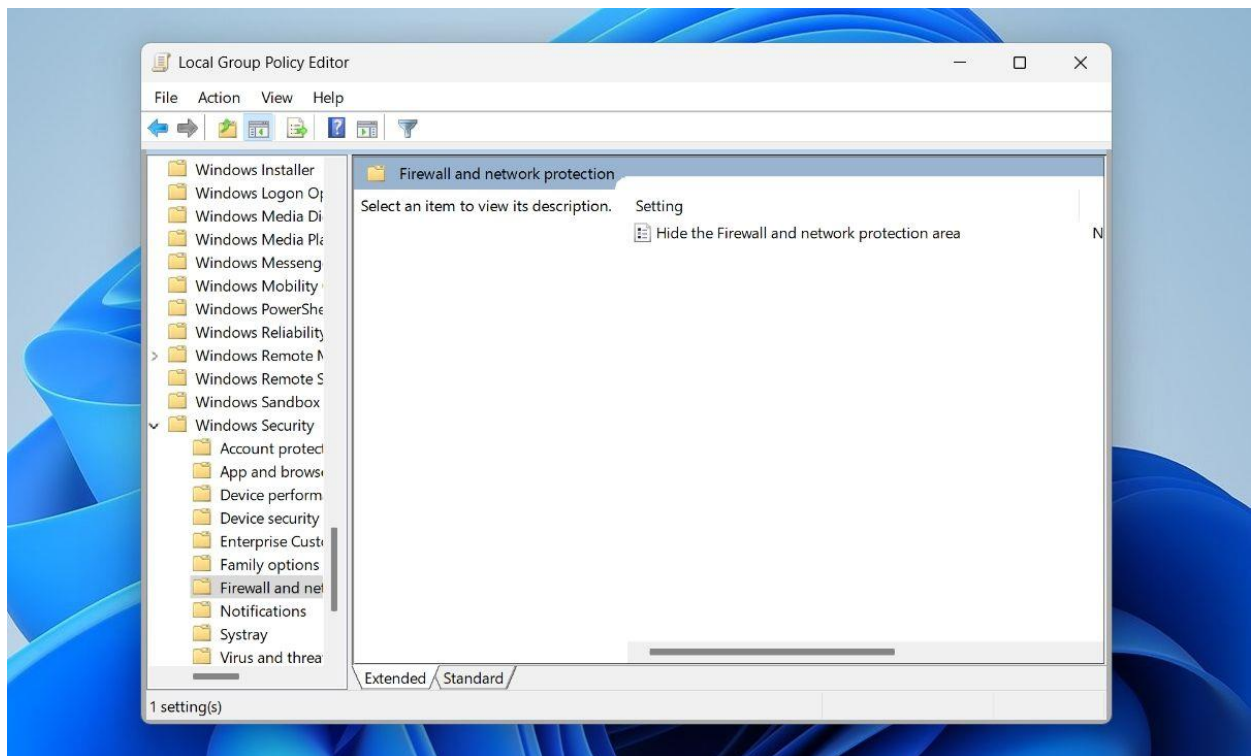
Nevertheless, here's how to use Local Group Policy Editor to hide the Firewall & Network area in Windows Security:

1. Press the **Win + R** hotkeys to open the Run dialog box.
2. Type **gpedit.msc** and press **Enter**. It'll open the Local Group Policy Editor.
3. Head towards the f
- 4.

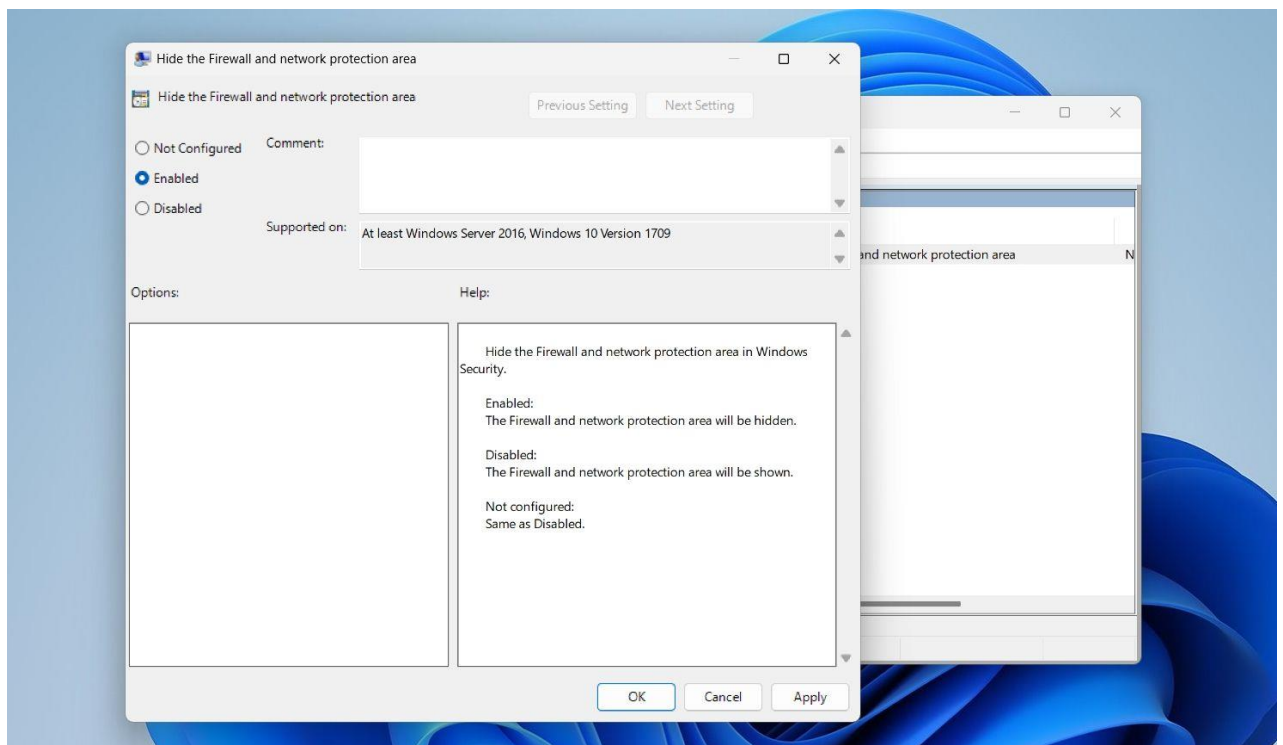
Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components >
Windows Security > Firewall and network protection

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5. Double-click the **Hide the Firewall and network protection area** to open its edit window.



6. Select the **Enabled** option.



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7. Click **Apply** > **OK** to save the changes.

That's it. You might need to restart your computer for the changes to take effect.

If you want to unhide the Firewall & Network area, open the Local Group Policy Editor again and repeat the above steps. At the very end, select the **Disabled** option and then save the settings.

Keep Your Network Settings Safe and Secure

It's very important to hide the Firewall & Network protection area if you don't want others to view or change the important settings of your computer. You disable this area using the Local Group Policy Editor, as mentioned above.

Meanwhile, you might be interested to know different ways to open the Windows Security app.

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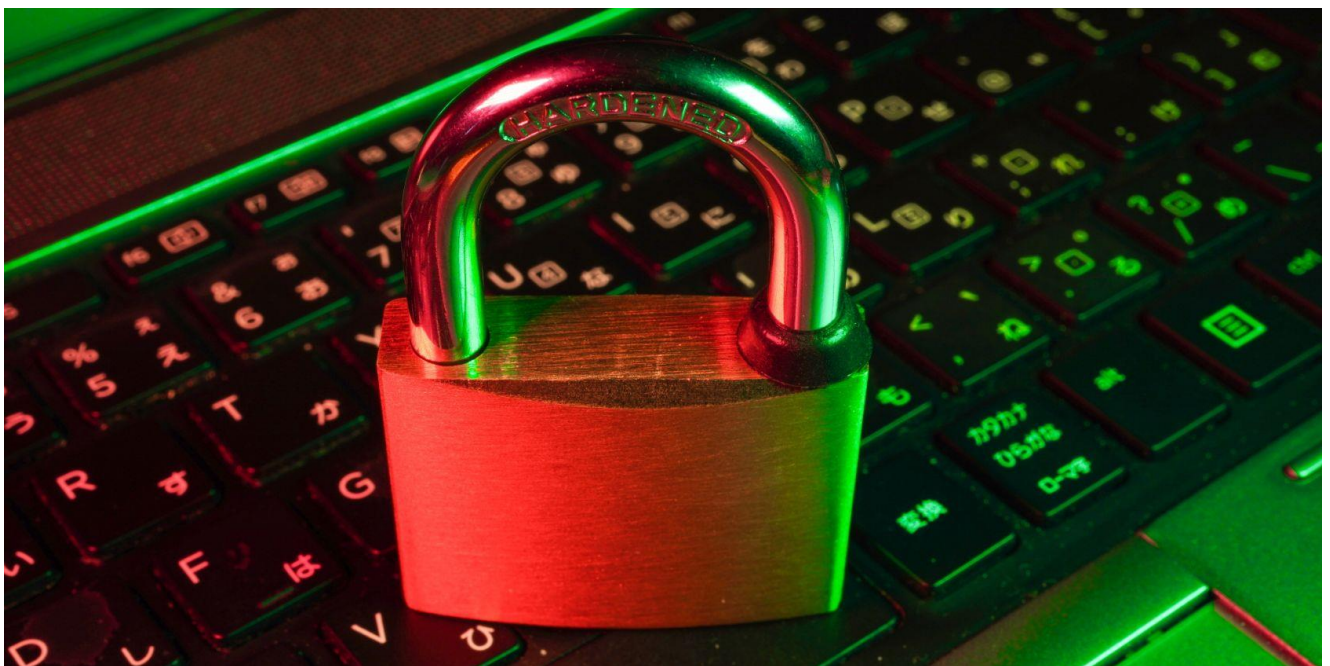
11 Ways You Can Open the Windows Security App in Windows 11

By [Jack Slater](#)

Published Jun 26, 2022

Source : <https://www.makeuseof.com/windows-11-security-app-open/>

Did you know you can create a desktop shortcut for Windows Security on Windows 11? Here's how to do that and more.



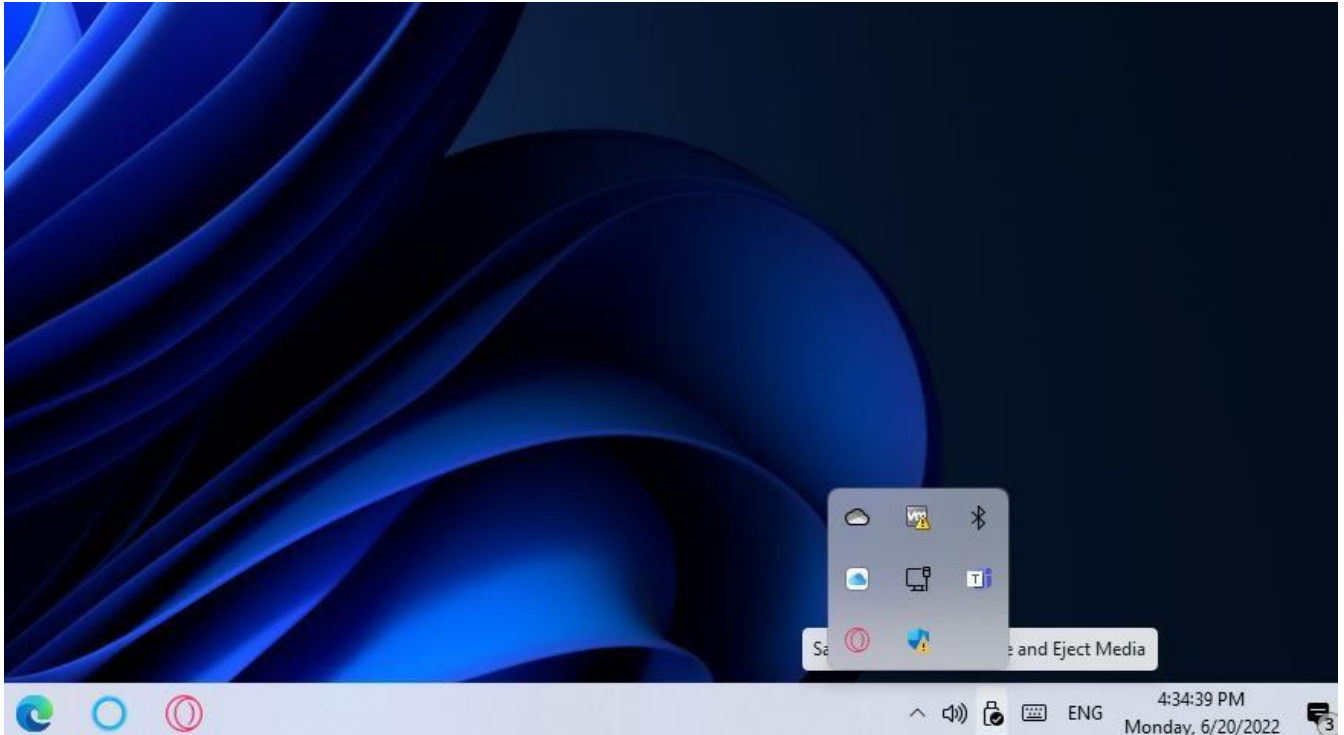
Windows Security (formerly Defender) is the antivirus app bundled with Windows 11. The app's real-time scanning protects PCs from viruses and other forms of malware. So, it's an important Windows app if you don't have any alternative third-party antivirus utility installed.

Users will need to open Windows Security to manually start custom or quick scans, configure antivirus settings, and set up file and folder exclusions among other things. You can also adjust some firewall options from that app. These are 11 alternative ways you can open Windows Security in Windows 11.

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1. How to Open Windows Security From the System Tray

This first method is probably one of the quickest ways to open Windows Security. Simply click the Windows Security (shield) icon that's in the system tray on the far right of your taskbar. If you've got the Windows Security notification taskbar corner setting turned off, you'll need to click a **Show hidden icons** up arrow to view the overflow menu.

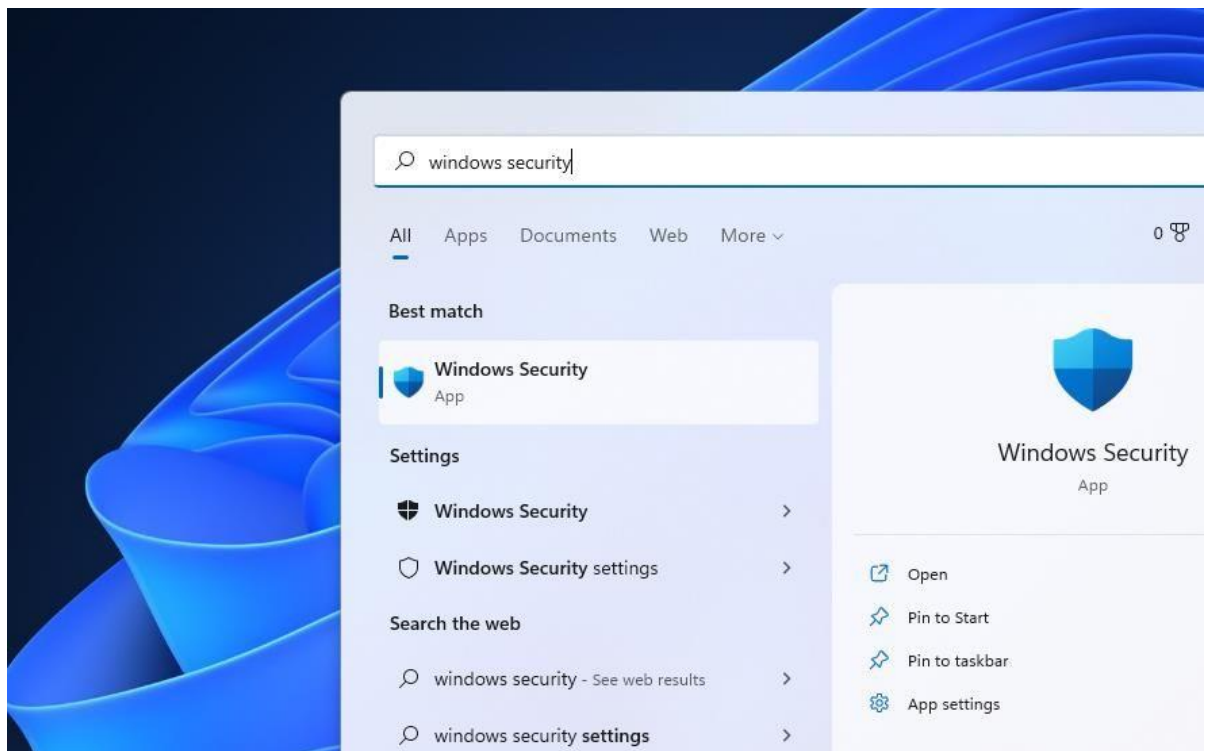


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2. How to Open Windows Security With Windows 11's Search Tool

It's easy to find most Windows 11's apps with the Type here to search box. Entering a clear keyword for finding the antivirus app there will do the trick. This is how to bring up Windows Security with that search box:

1. Open up the Start menu to click inside the Type here to search box there.
2. Input **Windows Security** within your search box.



3. Then select Windows Security to bring up that app's **Home** tab.

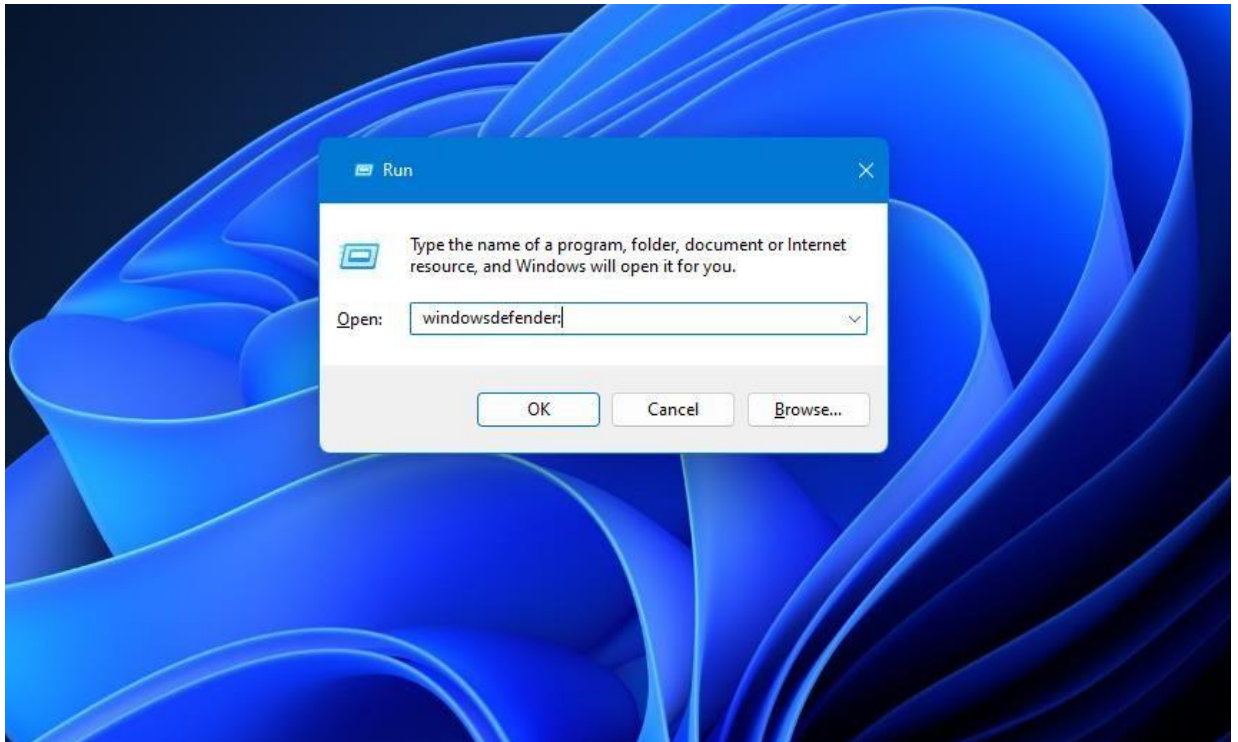
Alternatively, you can open different Windows Security tabs by entering keyword variations. For example, you can select to open the **Virus and threat protection** tab by inputting **virus** in the search box. So, try modifying your search keyword to find and open a more specific **Windows Security** tab.

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3. How to Open Windows Security With Run

The Run dialog provides another quick way to bring up Windows Security. To open Windows Security with that app, you'll need to enter a specific Run command in it as follows:

1. [Start Run](#) by holding down the **Windows** key and pressing **R**.
2. Type **windowsdefender**: within the Open box.



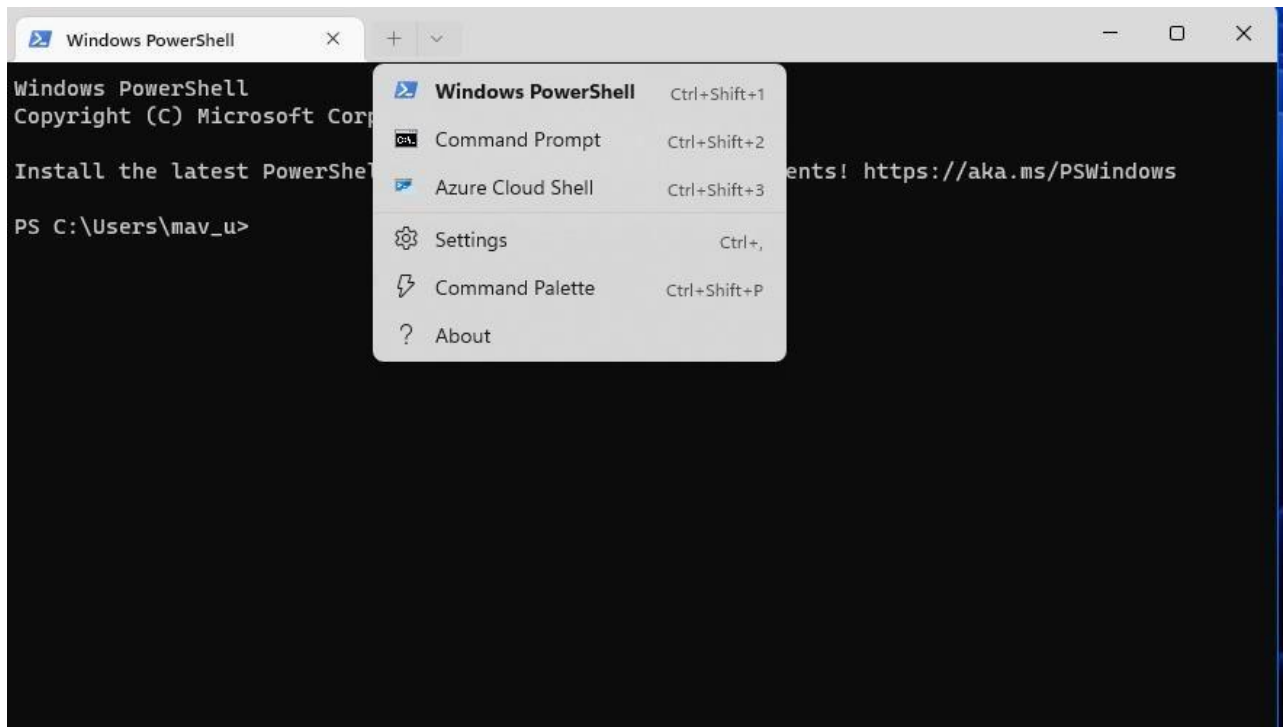
3. Click **OK** to open Windows Security's **Home** tab.

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4. How to Open Windows Security From the Windows Terminal

Command Prompt and PowerShell are two command-line shells you can utilize within the Windows Terminal app. You can open Windows Security with either. This is how to bring up Windows Security from Windows Security.

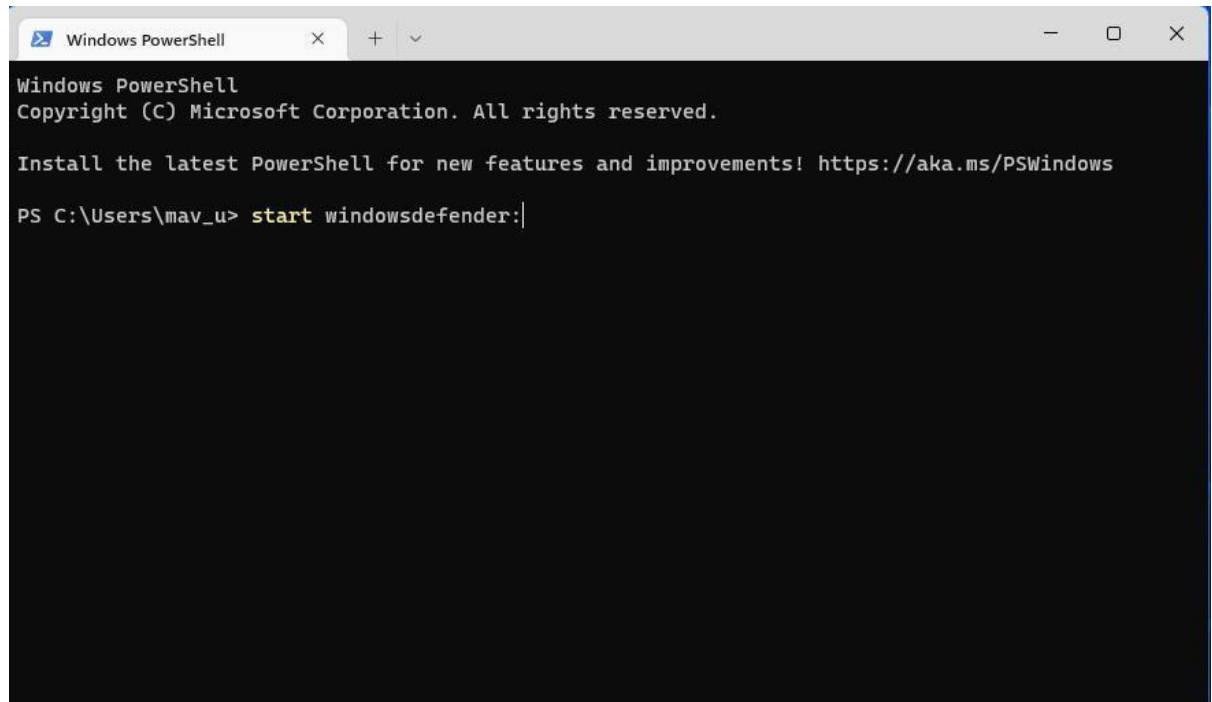
1. Press **Win + X** and select **Windows Terminal (Admin)** on the menu that appears.
2. Click the **Open a new tab** option along the top of Windows Terminal.



3. Select the **Command Prompt** or **Windows PowerShell** command-line shell option you prefer.
4. Input this Windows Security command in the selected command-line tab:

```
start windowsdefender:
```

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```
Windows PowerShell
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Install the latest PowerShell for new features and improvements! https://aka.ms/PSWindows

PS C:\Users\mav_u> start windowsdefender:
```

5. Press the **Enter** button to execute.

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5. How to Open Windows Security via the Settings

The Settings app provides a slightly less direct way to open Windows Security. Nevertheless, you can still open Windows Security from there whenever you've got Settings up. Here are the steps for opening Windows Security from Settings:

1. [Open Settings](#) in the quickest way by pressing **Win + I**.
2. Click **Privacy & security** on Settings' navigation sidebar.
3. Select **Windows Security** to bring up options for opening that app.
4. Press the **Open Windows Security** button.



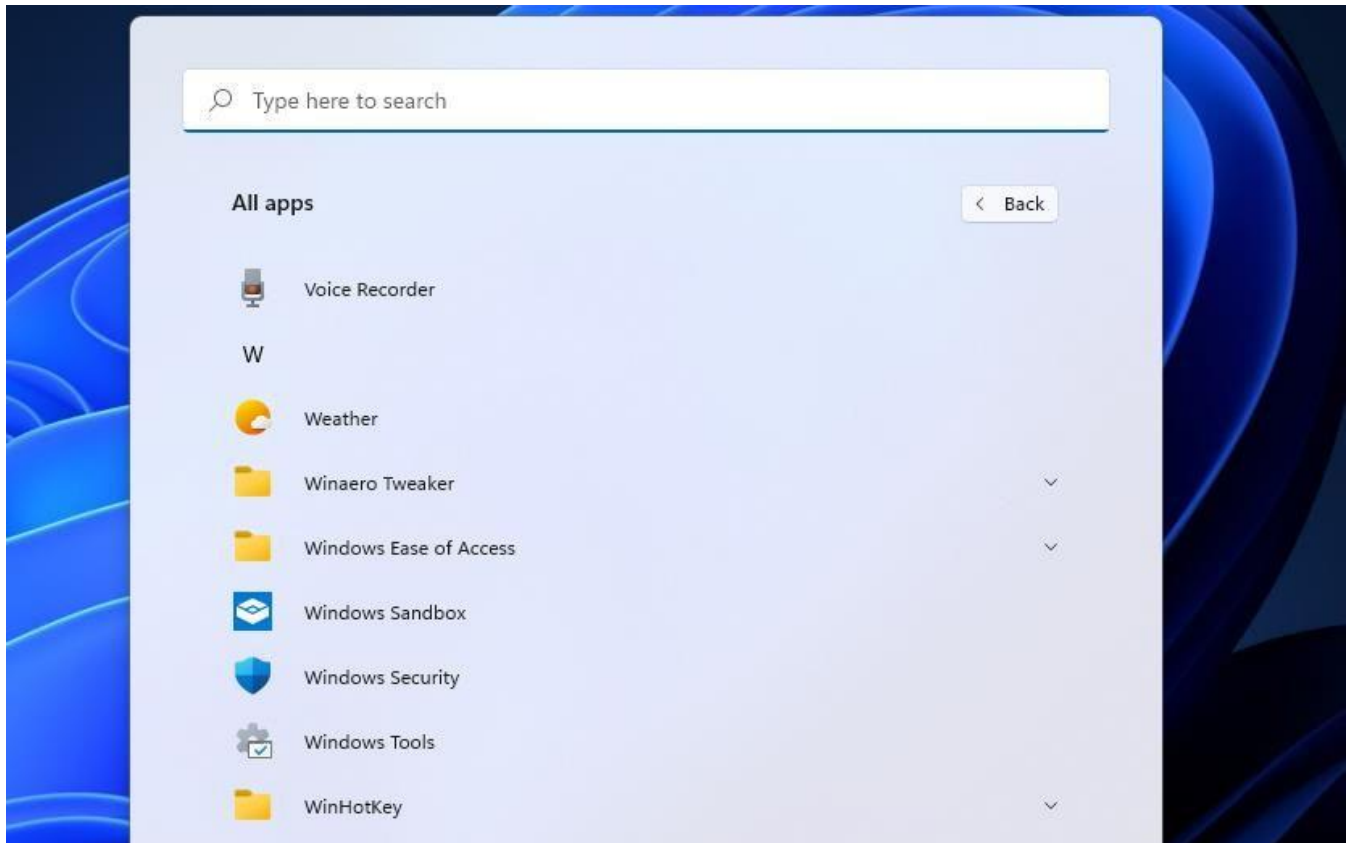
5. Alternatively, you can open a more specific Windows Security tab by selecting it under the "Protection areas" heading.

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6. How to Open Windows Security From the Start Menu

Windows Security is also accessible on the Start Menu. However, it's not pinned to the front of the menu. You can open it from the Start menu's app index as follows:

1. Click **Start** to bring up Windows 11's main menu.
2. Select **All apps** to view the shortcuts list.
3. Scroll down to Windows Security, and select that app to open it.



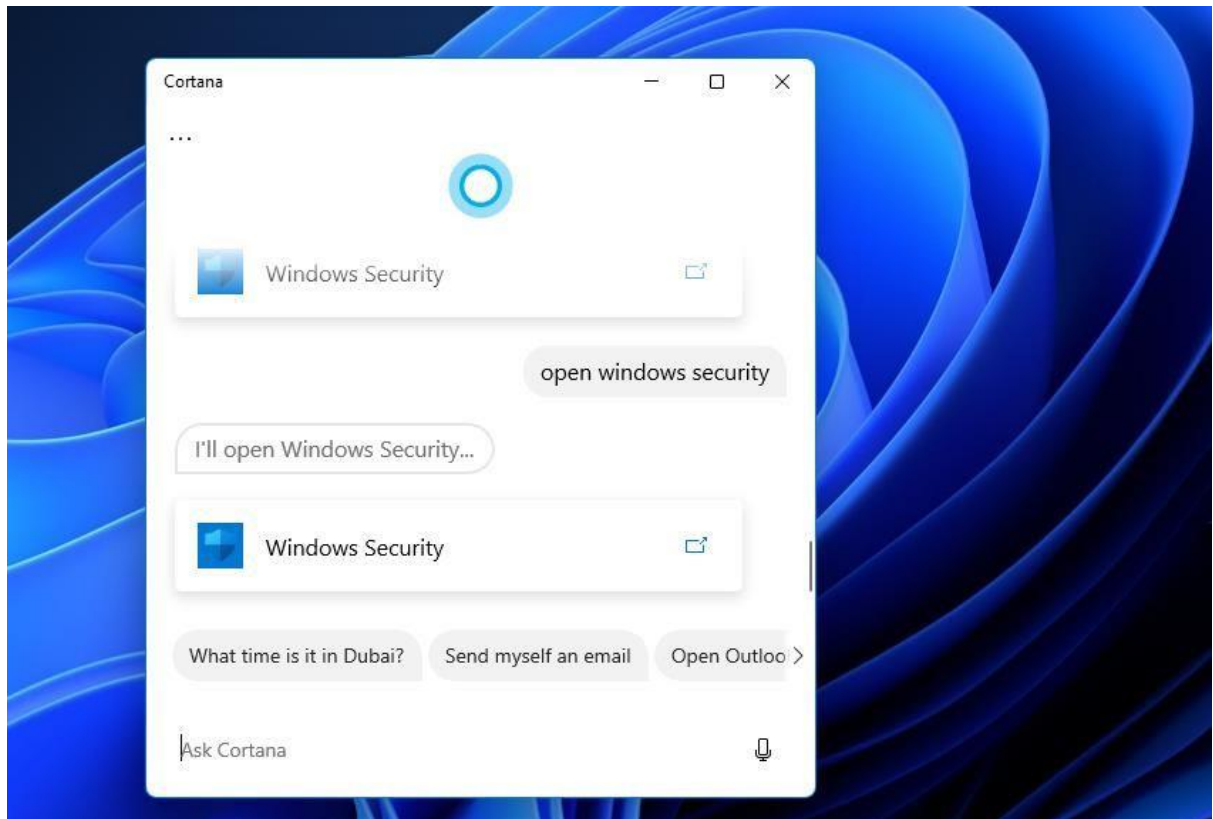
You can also pin Windows Security to the Start menu. Right-click Windows Security on the Start menu's app index to select a **Pin to Start** option for it. Then you'll be able to click a pinned shortcut for that app on the front of the menu.

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7. How to Open Windows Security With Cortana

Cortana is a useful virtual assistant app with which you can start Windows 11's apps and tools. That virtual assistant enables users to open Windows Security with both text and voice commands. This is how you can open Windows Security with Cortana:

1. Click Cortana's circle icon on the taskbar.
2. Type **open Windows Security** in the Ask Cortana text box.
3. Press **Enter** to bring up Windows Security.



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4. To open the antivirus app with a voice command, click the **Speak to Cortana** button. Then say “open Windows Security” near your PC’s microphone.

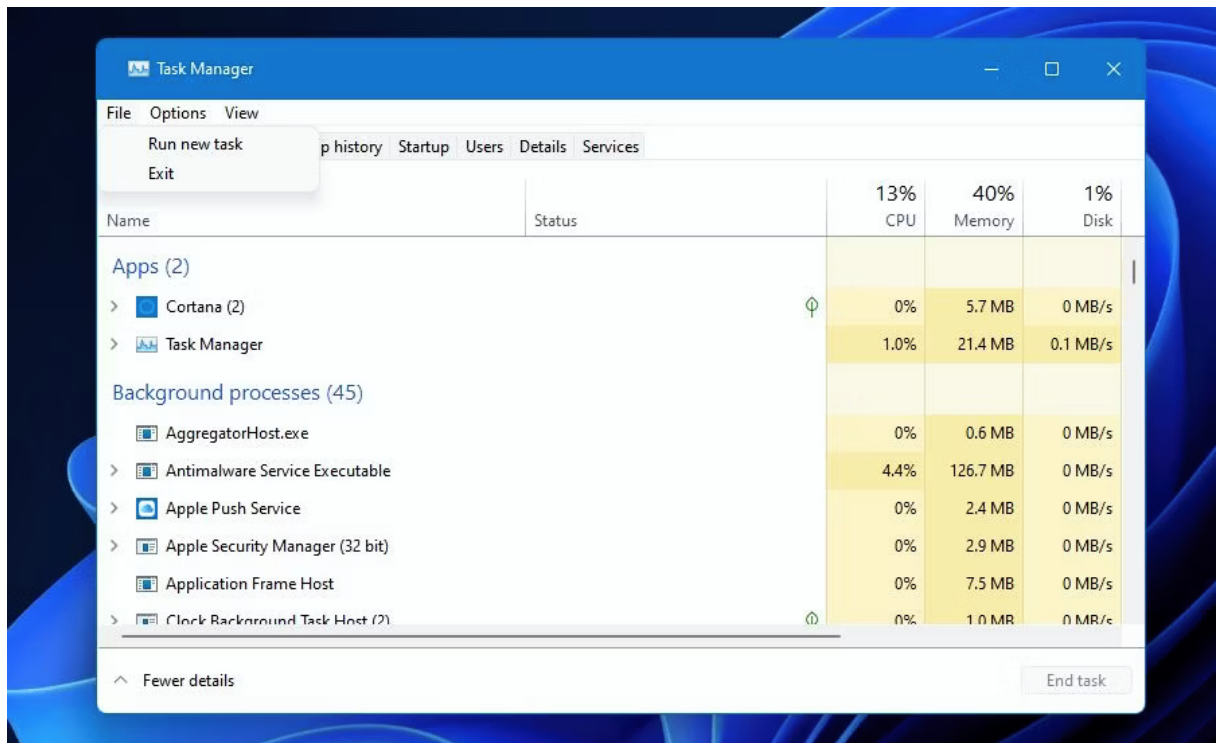


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8. How to Open Windows Security via Task Manager

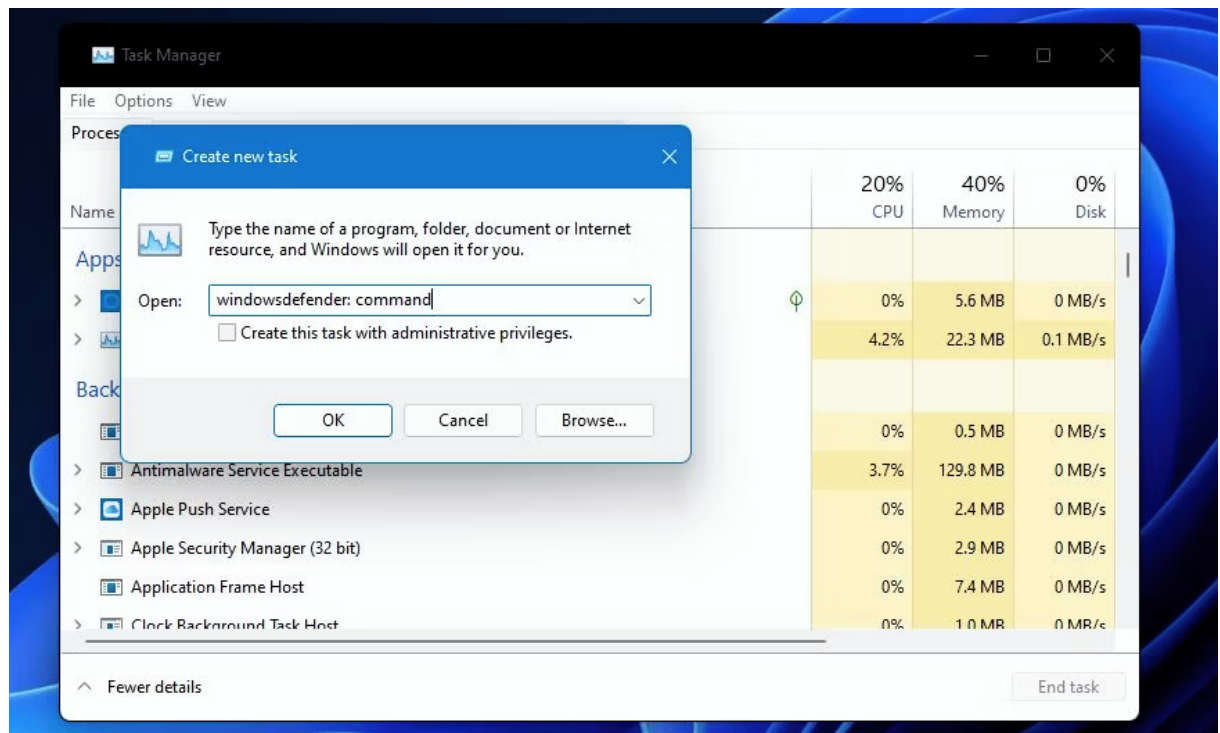
The Task Manager incorporates a Create a new task feature with which you can start apps. You can open Windows Security with that feature whenever you're utilizing Task Manager as follows:

1. Right-click **Start** (or the taskbar) and select **Task Manager**.
2. Click **File** and then the **Run new task** option.



3. Input the **windowsdefender:** command in the Create new task window.

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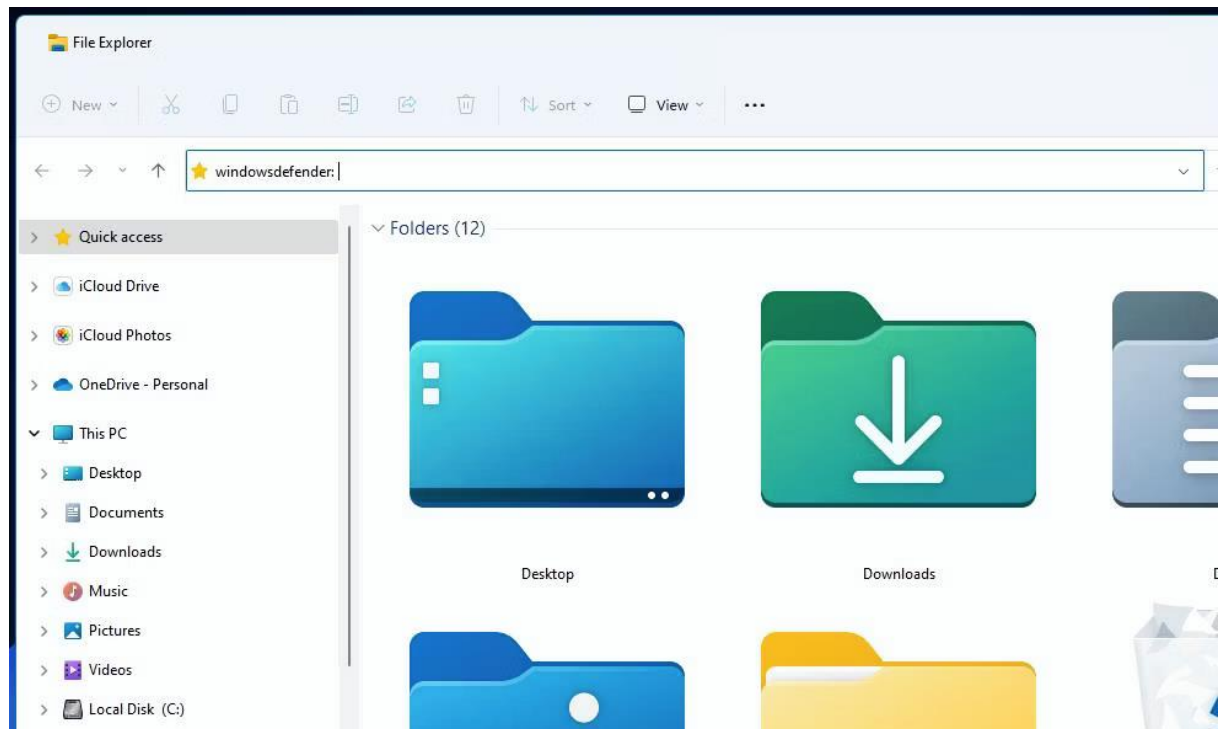
4. Select **OK** to launch the antivirus utility.

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9. How to Open Windows Security From File Explorer

You can open built-in apps by entering Run commands for them within File Explorer's folder location bar. To open Windows Security with Explorer, follow these quick steps:

1. Click the folder library icon along the taskbar to open Windows 11's Explorer file manager.
2. Type **windowsdefender:** in Explorer's folder path bar.



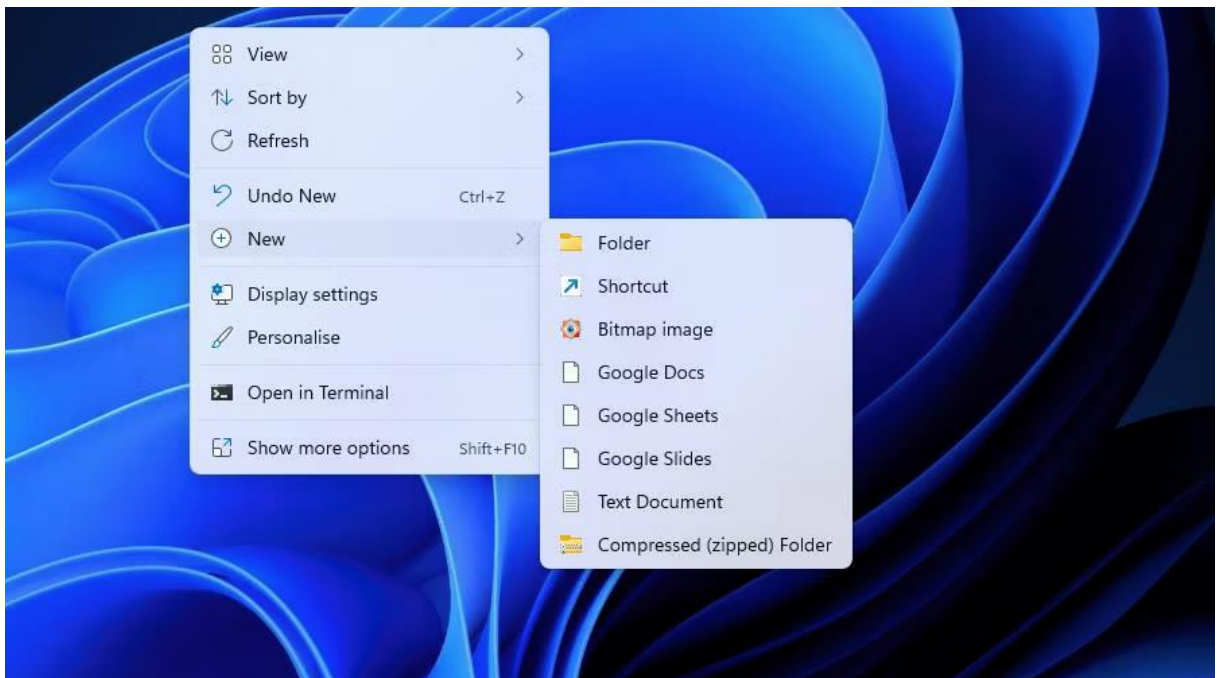
3. Press the **Return** button to bring up Windows Security.

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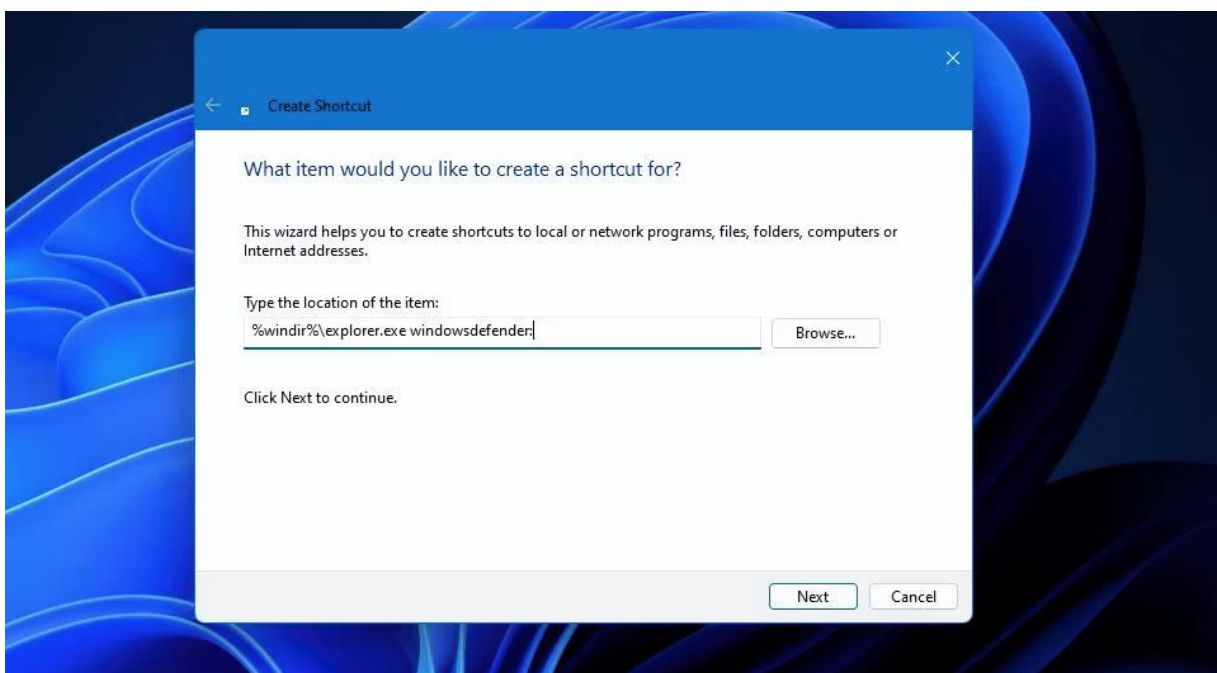
10. How to Open Windows Security With a Desktop Shortcut

You can make Windows Security accessible from Windows 11's desktop by adding a shortcut for it there. Then you can open the antivirus app with that desktop shortcut whenever needed. This is how to add Windows Security to the desktop with the Create Shortcut tool:

1. Right-click on a desktop wallpaper area to select the **New** and **Shortcut** context menu options.



2. Input **%windir%\explorer.exe windowsdefender:** within the Create Shortcut tool's location box, and select **Next**.



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3. Erase the default shortcut name, and type **Windows Security** in the text box.
4. Click the **Finish** option to add the desktop shortcut.
5. Double-click the Windows Security shortcut to open the antivirus app.

That shortcut will open Windows Security's **Home** tab. You can also set up desktop shortcuts that open different **Windows Security** tabs. To do so, you'll need to enter these alternative locations in the Create Shortcut tool:

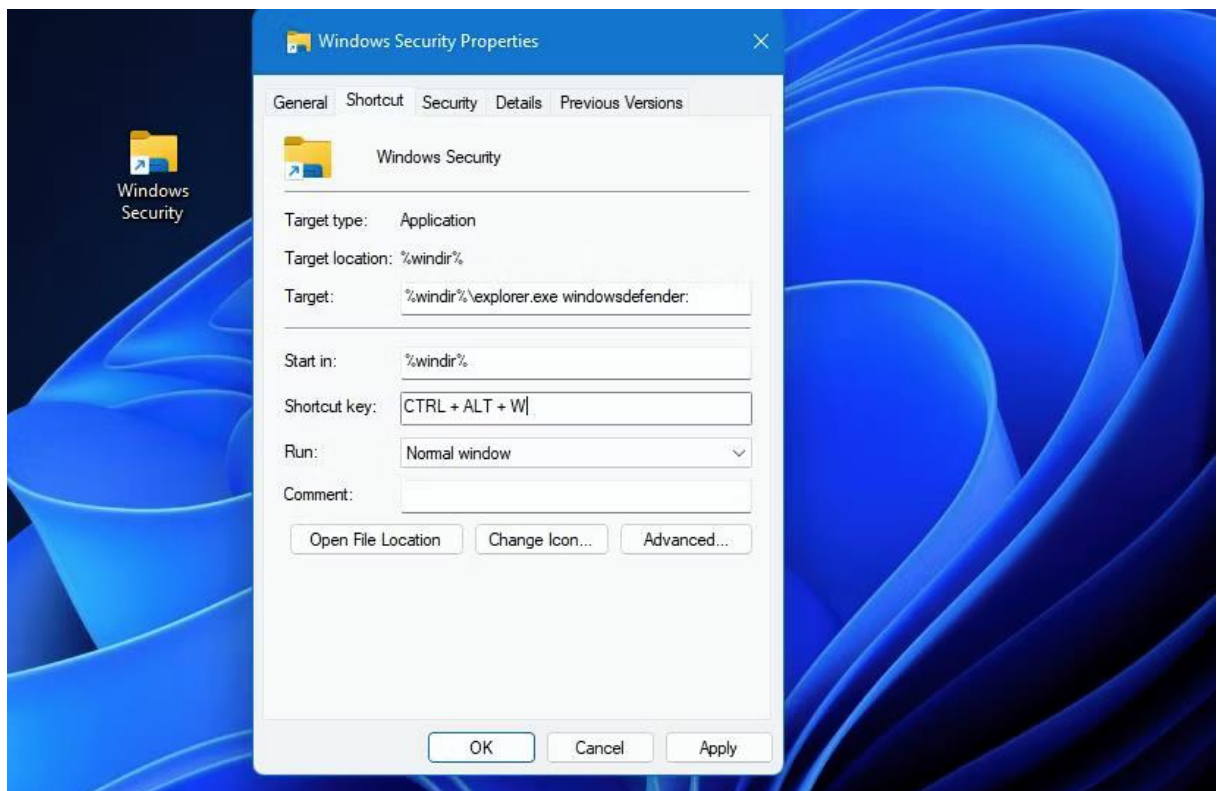
- **Account protection:** %windir%\explorer.exe windowsdefender://account
- **Virus & threat protection:** %windir%\explorer.exe windowsdefender://threat
- **Browser control:** %windir%\explorer.exe windowsdefender://appbrowser
- **Firewall and network:** %windir%\explorer.exe windowsdefender://network

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11. How to Open Windows Security With a Keyboard Shortcut

Do you prefer keyboard shortcuts to desktop ones? If so, you can set up a convenient hotkey for opening Windows Security in about a couple of minutes. Follow these quick steps to set up a Windows Security hotkey:

1. Add a Windows Security shortcut to the desktop as covered in method 10.
2. Right-click Windows Security's shortcut icon to select its **Properties** option.
3. Next, click anywhere in the Shortcut key box.
4. Press **W** to establish a **Ctrl + Alt + W** key combo for opening Windows Security.



5. Select **Apply** to set the new Windows Security hotkey.
6. Click **OK** to exit the properties window for the desktop shortcut.

Press the **Ctrl + Alt + W** keys at the same time to open Windows Security. That hotkey will work so long as you don't delete the desktop shortcut it's based on.

What's Your Favorite Way to Open Windows Security?

So, you can open Windows Security from Settings, File Explorer, system tray, Task Manager, Run, Windows Terminal, Cortana, Start menu, and the search tool. Or you can immediately open that antivirus app with desktop or keyboard shortcuts instead. Open Windows Security in whatever way you prefer.